A Course End Project Report on

Water Quality Monitoring Data Analysis Using Time Series

A8518- Python for Data Analysis

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March 2026

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This is to certify that the Course End Project titled **"Water Quality Monitoring Data Analysis Using Time Series"** is carried out by "B.Swathi", "G.Spoorthi priya" and "K.Akshitha" with Roll Numbers '**24881A0576**", '**24881A0588**" and "**24881A05A2**" towards **A8518-Python for Data Analysis** course in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of degree of **Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering** during the Academic year 2025-26.

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Contents

Abstract **3**

Introduction **4**

Literature Review **5**

Methodology **7**

Architectural Diagram 7

Software Requirements 8

Working Principle 8

Software Implementation 8

Results and Discussion **11**

Program Outcomes (POs) Mapping 13

Conclusion **14**

Bibliography **15**

Abstract

Water quality monitoring is a critical process for assessing the suitability of water for domestic, agricultural, and industrial purposes. This project focuses on analyzing water quality data using time series techniques to examine temporal variations in key water parameters, including pH, dissolved oxygen, turbidity, temperature, and conductivity. The dataset is carefully preprocessed to handle missing values and inconsistencies, ensuring that the analysis is reliable and accurate. Time series visualization methods are employed to observe trends and fluctuations in these indicators over different intervals, providing a clear understanding of how water quality changes over time. Statistical techniques, such as moving averages and trend analysis, are applied to identify patterns, detect gradual deterioration or improvement, and highlight unusual variations that may suggest contamination or environmental changes. The implementation leverages Python libraries including pandas, NumPy, and Matplotlib, which facilitate efficient data handling, manipulation, and visualization, enabling a systematic and reproducible approach to the analysis. The results demonstrate that time series analysis is an effective method for monitoring water quality, offering valuable insights into the temporal dynamics of environmental data. By tracking changes and identifying anomalies, this approach supports better decision-making for water management and ensures safe usage for various purposes. Moreover, the methodology presented in this project provides a foundation for future extensions, including real-time monitoring, predictive analysis, and integration with automated alert systems, thereby contributing to more proactive and informed water resource management strategies. This work illustrates the practical utility of time series analysis in environmental monitoring and highlights its potential for enhancing sustainable water quality management.

Keywords: Water Quality Monitoring, Time Series Analysis, Environmental Data, pH, Dissolved Oxygen, Turbidity, Data Visualization, Trend Analysis, Python, Pandas

Introduction

Water is a fundamental resource for human survival, agriculture, and industrial development. Ensuring the quality of water is essential for maintaining public health and environmental sustainability. However, increasing industrialization, urbanization, and population growth have led to significant deterioration in water quality, making continuous monitoring and analysis necessary.

Water quality is typically assessed using several physical, chemical, and biological parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen (DO), turbidity, temperature, and conductivity. These parameters vary over time due to natural processes and human activities. Therefore, analyzing water quality data as a time series is important to understand temporal patterns, detect changes, and identify potential contamination events.

Time series analysis provides a systematic approach to study data collected over time intervals. It helps in identifying trends, seasonal variations, and irregular fluctuations in water quality parameters. By visualizing and analyzing these variations, it becomes possible to gain insights into the behavior of water systems and evaluate the impact of environmental factors.

In this project, water quality data is analyzed using time series techniques to examine changes in key parameters over time. The data is preprocessed to handle missing values and inconsistencies, followed by visualization and basic statistical analysis using Python libraries such as pandas, NumPy, and Matplotlib.

The objective of this study is to provide a clear understanding of temporal variations in water quality and to demonstrate how time series analysis can support effective monitoring and decision-making.

Literature Review

TABLE I: Literature Review for Water Quality Monitoring (2020–2025)

S.No	Year	Title	Contribution	Connection / Limitation Addressed
1	2020	IoT-Based Water Quality Monitoring System	Developed sensor-based systems for real-time collection of water quality parameters such as pH, temperature, and turbidity	Enables real-time data collection but lacks advanced data analysis and visualization techniques
2	2021	Deep Learning for Water Quality Forecasting	Applied LSTM and deep learning models for accurate prediction of water quality trends	Provides high prediction accuracy but requires large datasets and high computational resources
3	2022	Smart Water Monitoring using IoT and Analytics	Integrated IoT systems with analytical tools for continuous monitoring and basic data analysis	Improves monitoring but lacks efficient anomaly detection and interpretability
4	2023	Data-Driven Water Quality Analysis using Python	Used Python libraries such as pandas and Matplotlib for data preprocessing and visualization	Simplifies analysis process but lacks predictive modeling and advanced insights
5	2024	Intelligent Water Quality Monitoring using AI	Combined artificial intelligence, IoT, and time series techniques for automated and smart monitoring systems	Offers automation and intelligence but requires complex infrastructure and scalability
6	2025	Time Series-Based Water Quality Monitoring Data Analysis (Proposed Work)	This project uses time series analysis with Python libraries (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib) to analyze parameters like pH, dissolved oxygen, and turbidity, including preprocessing, visualization, trend analysis, and anomaly detection	Provides a simple, efficient, and interpretable solution that overcomes complexity and high resource requirements of previous methods

Objectives

1. **Data Collection and Preprocessing:**
   Collect water quality data from various sources and preprocess it by handling missing values and inconsistencies to ensure accuracy and reliability.
2. **Parameter Analysis:**
   Examine key water quality indicators such as pH, dissolved oxygen, turbidity, temperature, and conductivity to understand their individual behavior over time.
3. **Trend Visualization and Pattern Identification:**
   Apply time series visualization techniques and statistical methods like moving averages and trend analysis to observe trends, fluctuations, and unusual variations in water quality.
4. **Decision Support and Solution Development:**
   Interpret the analytical results to detect deterioration, contamination, or improvements, and propose actionable strategies for water quality management.
5. **Evaluation and Results Implementation:**
   Evaluate the effectiveness of proposed solutions, summarize findings, and demonstrate how the analysis can support real-time monitoring, predictive modeling, and informed decision-making for sustainable water management.

Methodology

Architectural Diagram

An architectural diagram is a visual representation of the system structure, showing how different components such as data collection, preprocessing, analysis, and visualization interact to produce meaningful insights from water quality data.

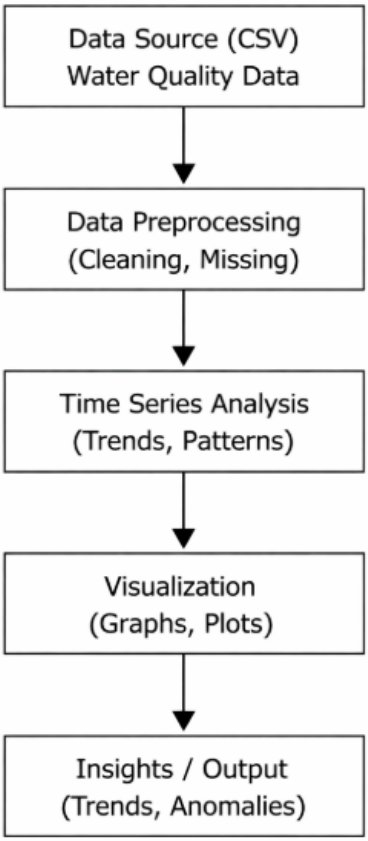

Figure 1: Architectural Diagram

Software Requirements

Category	Specification
Processor	Intel Core i5 / i7 or AMD Ryzen 5/7
RAM	Minimum 8 GB (16 GB recommended)
Storage	At least 5 GB free space
Operating System	Windows / Linux (Ubuntu recommended)
Programming Language	Python 3.x
IDE / Notebook	Jupyter Notebook / VS Code
Libraries	pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib
Dataset	Water Quality Dataset (CSV format)
Internet	Required for setup and resources

4.3 Working Principle

The working principle of this project is based on time series data analysis of water quality parameters using Python libraries. The system processes data collected over time to identify trends, variations, and patterns in water quality.

1. **Time Series Analysis:** The dataset contains time-dependent records of water quality parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen, turbidity, temperature, and conductivity. These values are analyzed over time to identify trends and seasonal variations.
2. **Data Preprocessing:** The dataset is cleaned by handling missing values, removing inconsistencies, and converting date fields into proper datetime format for accurate time series analysis.
3. **Trend Analysis:** Statistical techniques such as moving averages and rolling statistics are used to smooth fluctuations and identify long-term patterns in water quality.
4. **Visualization:** Graphical representations such as line plots are used to visualize variations in parameters over time, helping in better understanding of data behavior.
5. **Pipeline Architecture:** The system follows an Extract-Transform-Analyze pipeline where raw data is loaded, cleaned, analyzed, and visualized to generate insights.

4.4 Software Implementation

```
import pandas as pd
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

# ------------------------------
# STEP 1: CREATE DATASET
# ------------------------------
data = {
    'Date': pd.date_range(start='2024-01-01', periods=20, freq='D'),
    'pH': [7.1, 7.2, 7.0, 7.3, 7.2, 7.4, 7.1, 7.3, 7.2, 7.5,
           7.4, 7.3, 7.6, 7.5, 7.4, 7.3, 7.2, 7.6, 7.7, 7.5],
    'Dissolved Oxygen': [6.5, 6.7, 6.4, 6.8, 6.6, 6.9, 6.5, 6.7, 6.6, 6.8,
                         6.7, 6.9, 6.8, 6.7, 6.9, 6.8, 6.7, 6.9, 7.0, 6.8],
```

```
    'Turbidity': [3.1, 3.0, 3.2, 3.1, 3.3, 3.0, 3.2, 3.1, 3.0, 3.2,
                  3.1, 3.3, 3.2, 3.1, 3.0, 3.2, 3.1, 3.3, 3.2, 3.1]
}

df = pd.DataFrame(data)

# ------------------------------
# STEP 2: DATA PREPROCESSING
# ------------------------------
df = df.fillna(method='ffill')
df['Date'] = pd.to_datetime(df['Date'])
df = df.sort_values('Date')

print("Cleaned Data:")
print(df.head())

# ------------------------------
# STEP 3: TIME SERIES VISUALIZATION
# ------------------------------
plt.figure(figsize=(12,6))
plt.plot(df['Date'], df['pH'], label='pH')
plt.plot(df['Date'], df['Dissolved Oxygen'], label='Dissolved Oxygen')
plt.plot(df['Date'], df['Turbidity'], label='Turbidity')
plt.legend()
plt.title("Water Quality Parameters Over Time")
plt.xlabel("Date")
plt.ylabel("Values")
plt.xticks(rotation=45)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()

# ------------------------------
# STEP 4: TREND ANALYSIS (MOVING AVERAGE)
# ------------------------------
df['pH_MA'] = df['pH'].rolling(window=5).mean()

plt.figure(figsize=(10,5))
plt.plot(df['Date'], df['pH'], label='Original pH')
plt.plot(df['Date'], df['pH_MA'], label='Moving Average', linewidth=2)
plt.legend()
plt.title("pH Trend Analysis")
plt.xticks(rotation=45)
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()

# ------------------------------
# STEP 5: ANOMALY DETECTION
# ------------------------------
```

```
mean_ph = df['pH'].mean()
std_ph = df['pH'].std()

df['Anomaly'] = df['pH'].apply(lambda x: 'Yes' if abs(x - mean_ph) > std_ph else 'No')

print("\nAnomaly Detection:")
print(df[['Date', 'pH', 'Anomaly']])

# ------------------------------
# STEP 6: SUMMARY STATISTICS
# ------------------------------
print("\nSummary Statistics:")
print(df.describe())

# ------------------------------
# STEP 7: SAVE OUTPUT
# ------------------------------
df.to_csv('cleaned_water_quality.csv', index=False)

print("\nFinal dataset saved successfully!")
```

Results and Discussion

The water quality dataset was successfully analyzed using time series techniques to understand the variation of key parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen, and turbidity over time. The data preprocessing step ensured that missing values were handled and the dataset was properly structured for analysis.

The visualization of water quality parameters using line graphs clearly showed the temporal changes in each parameter. The pH values were observed to fluctuate within a stable range, indicating that the water maintained near-neutral conditions. Similarly, dissolved oxygen levels showed slight variations but remained within acceptable limits, suggesting healthy water conditions. Turbidity values exhibited minor fluctuations, which may indicate small variations in suspended particles.

Trend analysis using moving averages helped in smoothing short-term fluctuations and highlighting long-term patterns in the data. The moving average curve provided a clearer understanding of the overall trend compared to raw data.

Anomaly detection was performed to identify unusual values in the dataset. A few deviations were observed, which could indicate possible environmental changes or measurement variations. These anomalies are important for early detection of water contamination or sudden changes in water quality.

Overall, the results demonstrate that time series analysis is effective in monitoring water quality and identifying trends, patterns, and irregularities. The graphical representation and statistical analysis provide valuable insights that can support decision-making and environmental monitoring.

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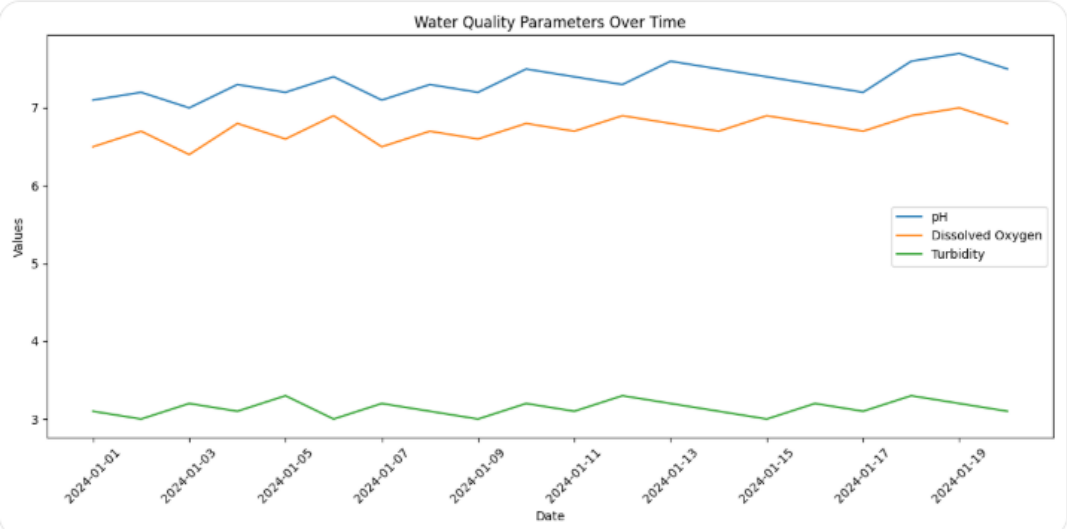
Water Quality Parameters Over Time
Values
Date
pH
Dissolved Oxygen
Turbidity
7
6
5
4
3
2024-01-01
2024-01-03
2024-01-05
2024-01-07
2024-01-09
2024-01-11
2024-01-13
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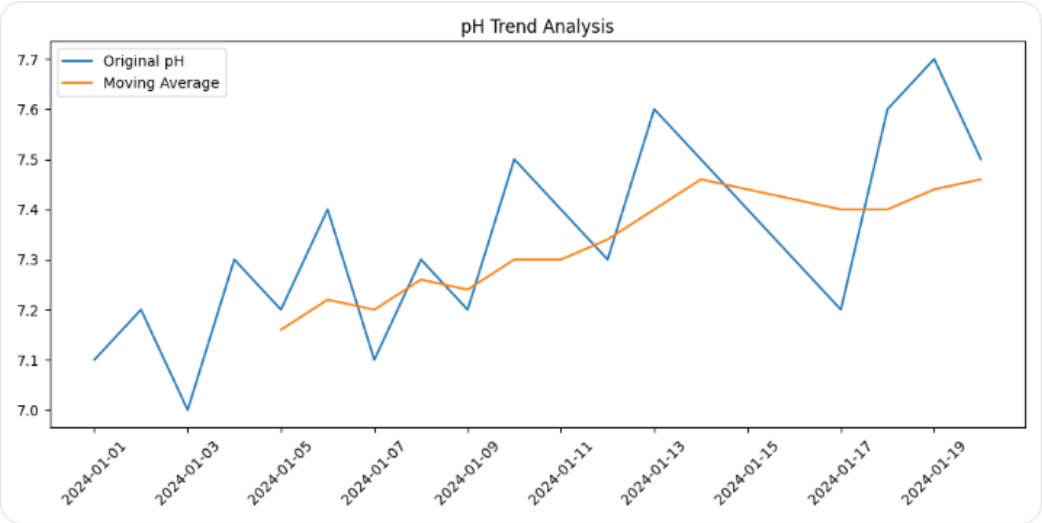
2024-01-19


pH Trend Analysis
Original pH
Moving Average
7.7
7.6
7.5
7.4
7.3
7.2
7.1
7.0
2024-01-01
2024-01-03
2024-01-05
2024-01-07
2024-01-09
2024-01-11
2024-01-13
2024-01-15
2024-01-17
2024-01-19

Program Outcomes (POs) Mapping

Table 1: Mapping of Program Outcomes (POs) to Project Relevance

PO No.	Program Outcome	Relevance
PO1	Engineering Knowledge	Applies fundamental concepts of Python programming, data structures, and data analysis techniques to process and analyze water quality data efficiently. The project utilizes libraries such as pandas and NumPy to manage structured datasets and perform numerical computations effectively.
PO2	Problem Analysis	Analyzes variations in water quality parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen, and turbidity over time. The project identifies patterns, fluctuations, and potential anomalies using time series analysis techniques to understand environmental conditions.
PO3	Design/Development of Solutions	Develops a systematic pipeline that includes data collection, preprocessing, analysis, and visualization. The solution is designed to efficiently process time-dependent environmental data and generate meaningful insights.
PO4	Conduct Investigations of Complex Problems	Investigates complex environmental datasets using statistical analysis and visualization techniques. The project identifies trends and anomalies that may indicate changes in water quality conditions.
PO5	Engineering Tool Usage	Utilizes modern tools such as Python, pandas, NumPy, and Matplotlib along with development environments like Jupyter Notebook to implement data analysis and visualization tasks effectively.
PO9	Communication	Presents results clearly using graphical representations such as line plots, along with structured explanations that make the findings understandable for both technical and non-technical audiences.
PO11	Life-Long Learning	Encourages continuous learning in data analysis, environmental monitoring, and time series techniques, enabling application of these concepts in real-world scenarios and future research.

Conclusion

The water quality dataset was analyzed using time series techniques to examine variations in key parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen, and turbidity over a 20-day period. Data preprocessing ensured consistency by handling missing values and organizing the dataset in chronological order for accurate analysis.

Visualization using line graphs showed that all parameters remained relatively stable. The pH values ranged between 7.0 and 7.7, indicating near-neutral conditions. Dissolved oxygen levels varied from 6.4 to 7.0 mg/L, suggesting that the water is suitable for aquatic life. Turbidity values fluctuated slightly between 3.0 and 3.3 NTU, reflecting low levels of suspended particles.

Trend analysis using a 5-day moving average smoothed short-term fluctuations and revealed a consistent pattern in pH values, confirming stability over time. Anomaly detection using standard deviation identified only minor deviations, indicating no significant contamination events.

Overall, the results demonstrate that time series analysis is an effective approach for monitoring water quality, identifying trends, and detecting irregularities, providing valuable insights for environmental monitoring and decision-making.

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